

Education

- 2019-present **PhD** – Carnivore Conflicts and Coexistence, Auburn University, US
Advisors: Christopher Lepczyk, Robert Gitzen
- 2016-2017 **PGD** – Geoinformatics, Twente University, Netherlands
Advisors: Sameer Saran, Gautam Talukdar
- 2013-2015 **MS** – Forestry, Forest Research Institute, India
Advisor: Deepak Mishra
- 2008-2010 **MS** – Biochemistry, Banaras Hindu University, India
Advisor: Srikrishna Saripella
- 2005-2008 **BS** – Zoology & Biochemistry (majors) & Entomology (minor), St. Xavier's College, India
Advisors: Smita Krishnan, Nandini Mangalore

Management and Research Experience

- 2024-present **Graduate Teaching Assistant**, College of Forestry, Wildlife & Environment, Auburn
Assisting and grading junior and honors level WILD 3280 class of ~120 students
- 2024-present **Graduate Research Assistant**, College of Forestry, Wildlife & Environment, Auburn
Organization of research work: data analysis, preparation of research paper summary and abstracts,
Presenting research posters and oral talks at conferences, writing grants
- Jun-Aug 2023 **Graduate Innovation Intern**, The Nature Conservancy, New York
Evaluate and develop indicators of socioeconomic baseline for the Blue Carbon Mangrove restoration project in Marismas Nacionales, Mexico
- 2021-2023 **Graduate Student Assistant**, Ralph Brown Draughton Library, Auburn University
Assisting patrons with research and technology queries; instructing patrons to locate and evaluate information meeting their needs; and supporting reference and collection development for the instructional function of the library.
- 2019-2021 **Graduate Research Assistant**, College of Forestry, Wildlife & Environment, Auburn
Organization of research work: data analysis, preparation of research paper summary and abstracts,
Presenting research posters and oral talks at conferences, writing grants
- 2013-2019 **Divisional Forest Officer**, Uttar Pradesh Forest Department, Govt. of India
Forest and wildlife management of Bulandshahr district, Uttar Pradesh (>1700 sq miles); extension and outreach; supervision of teams from 10 – 50 people; special projects – Mass Plantation Drives, Innovation and Technology Transfer, House Sparrow Campaign, Sarus Census; and presentation at conferences and meetings with political leaders.

Awards

- 2024 Drummond Outstanding International Graduate Student Fellowship, College of Forestry, Wildlife and Environment, Auburn University
- 2021 Trailblazing Work in Science Policy Award, Student Section, Ecological Society of America
- 2021 Outstanding International Student, International Student Organization, Auburn University
- 2020 Conservation Leaders for Tomorrow, Charlie Elliott Wildlife Centre, Georgia
- 2020 Katherine S. McCarter Graduate Student Policy Award, Ecological Society of America
- 2019 Appreciation for Outstanding Contribution to 2019 Guinness Record Mass Plantation Drive, Uttar Pradesh Forest Department
- 2018 Outstanding Achievement for Innovation in Technology Transfer, Uttar Pradesh Forest Department
- 2013 Indian Forest Service – 1st Rank, Union Public Service Commission
- 2011 All India Rank – 22 Life Sciences NET, Council of Scientific and Industrial Research
- 2010 Gold Medal – Biochemistry, Banaras Hindu University

Teaching

- Fall 2024 Teaching Assistant–Wildlife Habitat, Ecology and Management (3280), Auburn University
- Fall 2022 Guest Lecture–Structured Decision Making (7300), Auburn University
- Fall 2021 Guest Lecture–Natural Resource Management-SDM (7300), Auburn University
- Spring 2020 Teaching Assistant, Analysis for Wildlife Sciences (6750), Auburn University
- Fall 2010 Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Research Methodology, Delhi University
- 2008-2010 Science tutorials for middle school students at Public School, Mumbai

Grants and Fellowships

- 2024 Travel Fellowship, University of Wisconsin-Madison (\$600)
- 2024 Graduate Student Council Travel Fellowship, Auburn University (\$400)
- 2023-2025 German Centre for Integrative Biodiversity Research (iDiv) synthesis center Early Career Researcher working group titled “Fit-for-purpose models and frameworks for understanding and managing diverse social-ecological area-based conservation system.” (Working group)
- 2023 Ecological Society of America Leadership Award (\$500)
- 2023 Graduate Student Council Travel Fellowship, Auburn University (\$400)
- 2023 Conservation Science and Innovation in the Southeast, US FWS Grant titled “Evaluation of Environmental Pollution Data to Inform Decision Making for Migratory Birds of the Southeast US” (\$64k, co-PI)
- 2023 Early Career Award, University of New Brunswick (\$500)
- 2022 Graduate Student Council Travel Fellowship, Auburn University (\$300)
- 2022 Small Research Grant, The Rufford Foundation (£6k)
- 2022 Field Research Support, Global Tiger Forum (\$10k)
- 2021 British Ecological Society Travel Grant (£500)
- 2019-2021 Tiger's United University Consortium Tuition Fellowship, Auburn University (\$64k)
- 2010-2011 Junior Research Fellowship (JRF), CSIR, Govt. of India (Rs. 300k)

Publications

- In prep Lepczyk C.A., Fantle-Lepczyk J.E., Von Hagen R. L., **Prakash V.**, Chalkowski K., Gitzen R.A., & Hartman P. Lepczyk C.A. A structured decision-making framework to guide species de-extinction.
- In prep **Prakash V.**, Zhang Y. Q. Transaction Costs of mitigating human–tiger conflicts.
- Under review **Prakash V.**, Gitzen R. A. & Lepczyk C.A. Global geospatial trends in human–wildlife conflicts. [*PNAS*]
- Under review **Prakash V.**, Gitzen R. A. & Lepczyk C.A. Using participatory modeling and fuzzy logic cognitive mapping to understand carnivore conflicts and promote carnivore conservation. [*Biological Conservation*]
- Under revision **Prakash V.**, Von Hagen R. L., Gitzen R.A., Schulte B. A., & Lepczyk C. A. A multi-objective decision-analysis framework for addressing human-wildlife conflicts. [*Frontiers in Ecology and Environment*]
- 3) **Prakash V.**, Saran S., & Talukdar G. (2018). Delineating eco-sensitive zones using geospatial methods – A test case of Jhilmil Jheel Conservation Reserve. *ISPRS Annals of Photogrammetry, Remote Sensing and Spatial Information Sciences*, 4, pp 459-66.
 - 2) **Prakash V.**, Mishra D. (2015). Assessing the accuracy of QGIS vis-à-vis ERDAS in assessing the forest cover of Pilibhit district, Uttar Pradesh. (MS Thesis)
 - 1) **Prakash V.**, Srikrishna S. (2010). Characterization of PARK1 mutant allele in *Drosophila melanogaster*. (MS Thesis)

Conferences

- Aug 2024 **Prakash V.**, Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Where is the conflict? A review of the global distribution of human-wildlife conflicts. Talk, Ecological Society of America Annual Meeting, Long Beach, US.
- Mar 2024 **Prakash V.**, Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Application of fuzzy logic cognitive modeling to integrate socio-ecological knowledge for carnivore conflict management. Talk, Research Symposium, Auburn University, US.
- Aug 2023 **Prakash V.**, Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Using participatory modeling and fuzzy logic cognitive mapping to understand human-tiger conflicts. Poster, Ecological Society of America Annual Meeting, Portland, US.
- Jun 2023 **Prakash V.**, Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Bottom-up and top-down approach to understand human-tiger conflicts using fuzzy logic cognitive mapping. Poster, Predictive Ecology, Gordon Research Conference, Easton, US.
- Aug 2022 **Prakash V.**, Von Hagen R.L., Irwin E., Schulte B.A., Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Structured decision making to mitigate negative human wildlife conflicts – A case study of Elephants and Tigers. Talk, Ecological Society of America Annual Meeting, Montreal, Canada (virtual).
- Dec 2021 **Prakash V.**, Von Hagen R.L., Irwin E., Schulte B.A., Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Elephants and tigers and models, Elephants and Tigers and Models, Oh my! Structured decision making to mitigate negative human wildlife conflicts. Invited Talk, International Congress for Conservation Biology (virtual).
- Aug 2021 **Prakash V.**, Von Hagen R.L., Chalkowski K., Fantle-Lepczyk J., Gitzen R.A., Hartman P., Lepczyk C.A. Poster, Prioritization of species for de-extinction using Structured Decision Tools. Poster, Ecological Society of America – Annual Meeting (virtual).
- Sept 2020 Freeland Film Festival Panel: Rooting for Your Wild Mascot to End Pandemics. Panelist.
- Aug 2020 **Prakash V.**, Zhang Y. Mitigating Human-Wildlife Conflicts – Coasian Solution. Poster, Ecological Society of America – Annual Meeting (virtual).
- Jul 2020 **Prakash V.**, Zhang Y., Gitzen R.A., Lepczyk C.A. Veiled Cost of Conflict Resolution. Speed Talk, North American Congress for Conservation Biology Virtual Conference.
- Oct 2017 **Prakash V.**, Saran S., & Talukdar G. Delineating eco-sensitive zones using geospatial methods – A case study of Jhilmil Jheel Conservation Reserve. Paper, 38th Asian Conference of Remote Sensing.

Workshops

- 2024 State-Space Modelling Workshop, University of Wisconsin-Madison
- 2023 Preparing Future Faculty, Auburn University
- 2023 Network of Conservation Educators and Practitioners, AMNH
- 2022-2023 The Grad WINGS (Women+ in Geospatial Science) Workshop, UCGIS
- 2022 Exploring Best Practices in Research Mentor-Mentee Relationships Workshop, Office of Research Compliance, Auburn University
- 2022 Workshop on QGIS for Conservation, Rufford Foundation

- 2022 Student Leader Workshop, Auburn University
- 2022 Inclusive Pedagogy and Bridging International Borders Workshop, BEDEN
- 2020 Spatial Agent-Based Modelling – Introductory Workshop, SESYNC

Outreach

- 2023-2025 Asian Ecology Section, Ecological Society of America, Science Talks
- 2023-2024 Junior Division Judge (Grade 6-8), Alabama Science and Engineering Fair
- 2023 Young Voices of Science, Hubbard Brook Research Foundation
- 2021-2022 Outreach Coordinator at Auburn Chapter of Graduate Women in Science
- 2021-2024 Mentored international students for First Year Experience at Auburn
- 2020 [Freeland Film Festival panelist: Rooting for your wild Mascot to end pandemics](#)
- 2019 Sarus (*Grus antigone*) Conservation Talk at Bird Festival, Unnao
- 2018 House Sparrow (*Passer domesticus*) Awareness Campaign at Lucknow Zoo
- 2016 Wetland Awareness Workshop at Lakhimpur-Kheri High schools

Services & Activities

- 2023-2025 Student Liaison, Asian Ecology Section (AES), Ecological Society of America (ESA)
Organizing quarterly [AES talk](#) series 2023-2025 on Zoom.
- 2022-2023 Abstract Reviews, Ecological Society of America (ESA) Annual Meetings
- 2022-2023 Treasurer, Student Section, Ecological Society of America (ESA)
Planning and organizing outreach events on Zoom and at ESA Annual Meeting 2023, Judging Real Brown Travel Award 2023, and Trailblazing Award 2023, Booking, reservation and expenditures based on vendor quotes for Annual Meeting 2023 Mixer, Expenditure reports.
- 2022-2023 Vice President, International Student Organization (ISO), Auburn University
Planning and organizing 24 social hour every Friday for Fall 2022 and Spring 2023, Peace Dinner 2022, Mental Health Day 2022, Soccer Tournament 2023, and World Fair 2023, Booking, reservation and expenditures based on Tiger Dining and other vendors for all events, Expenditure reports.
- 2021-2022 Research and Assessment Director, Student Government Association (SGA), Auburn University
Researching and creating reports for SGA agenda, 2 hours service at university events every week.
- 2008-2010 Student Volunteer, Xavier's Resource Center for Visually Challenged
Mentoring, reading, writing, and assisting with school assignments, homework, projects and readings with a visually challenged student for 10 hours every week of Fall and Spring semester for 3 years.

Professional Certifications

- 2024-2029 Certified Ecologist, Ecological Society of America
- 2023 Cyber Security Training, Auburn University
- 2023 Business Innovation Foundation (National Association of State Boards of Accountancy :140940)
- 2023-2026 AU Basic RCR Training for ALL Faculty, Staff, Postdocs, and Students (CITI: 50323176)
- 2022 Cyber Security Training, Auburn University
- 2021-2024 Avoiding Group Harms - International Research Perspectives (CITI :43738374)
- 2021-2024 Conflicts of Interest in Research Involving Human Subjects (CITI: 43738372)
- 2021-2024 International Research – SBE (CITI: 43738365)
- 2021-2024 Internet Research – SBE (CITI: 43738366)
- 2021-2024 Cultural Competence in Research (CITI: 43738376)
- 2021-2024 IRB # 2 Social and Behavioral Emphasis - AU Personnel (CITI: 43738369)
- 2021 Soft Skills Training, Auburn University
- 2019 Title IX and Discrimination: Identifying and Responding to Sexual Misconduct, Auburn
- 2019 Security Awareness Training, Auburn University

Memberships

Society of Conservation Biology (SCB)

The Wildlife Society (TWS)

Ecological Society of America (ESA)

British Ecological Society (BES)

Association of American Geographers (AAG)

Ecologists Without Borders (EcoWB)

Women in Science and Engineering (WISE)

Indian Society of Remote Sensing (ISRS)